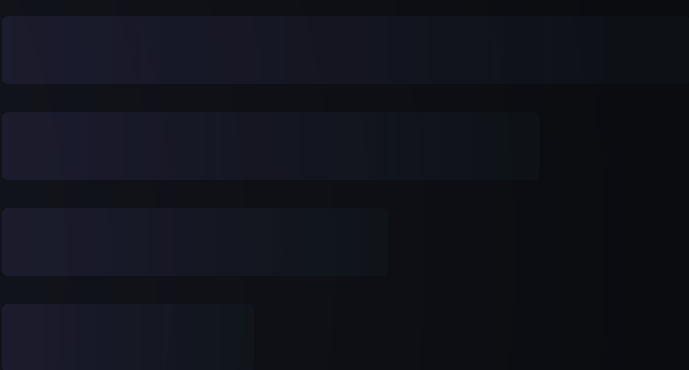




STRATA

Browse in context.

DOC 04 · UI / UX BRIEF

UI/UX Design Brief

Color, type, component gallery, and motion for a modern, minimal, premium browser interface — with zero AI visual language.

Version: 1.0

Date: September 2026

Status: Draft for team review

Owner: Design

strata — local-first browser
confidential — internal working document

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Design Philosophy

Strata's interface should feel **modern, fast, minimal, and premium** — closer in spirit to Linear, Arc, Raycast, and high-end native IDEs than to a traditional Chrome-style browser. Reference the mood of those products; do not copy their layouts. The name *Strata* gives the visual system its throughline: **layers** — websites beneath tabs, tabs beneath context, context beneath Moments, Moments beneath a navigable timeline.

```
Layer 1 → Websites  
Layer 2 → Tabs  
Layer 3 → Context  
Layer 4 → Moments  
Layer 5 → Timeline
```

✓ Do

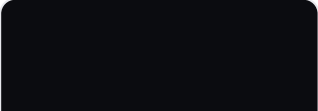
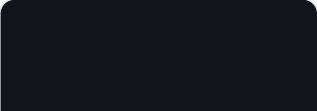
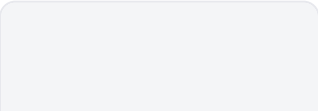
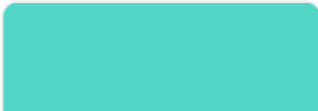
Subtle depth, restrained color, generous negative space, one strong accent moment per screen (usually the Continuum button or an active Moment).

✗ Don't

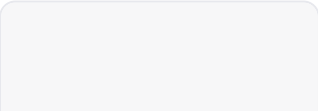
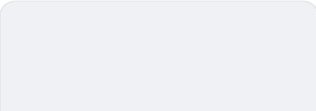
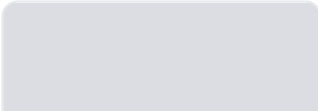
Chrome's dense toolbar, competing accent colors, decorative icons that don't map to a real action, AI-flavored visual motifs (sparkles, gradients implying "magic").

Color System

Dark (default)

 Background #0B0C10	 Surface #12141A	 Surface 2 #191C24	 Border #252936
 Primary text #F4F5F7	 Secondary text #858A98	 Accent #8B7CFF	 Secondary accent #54D6C7

Light

 Background #F7F7F8	 Surface #FFFFFF	 Surface 2 #F0F1F4	 Border #DCDDE3
 Primary text #17181C	 Secondary text #6B6F7A	 Accent #6957E8	 Secondary accent #159E91

RULE

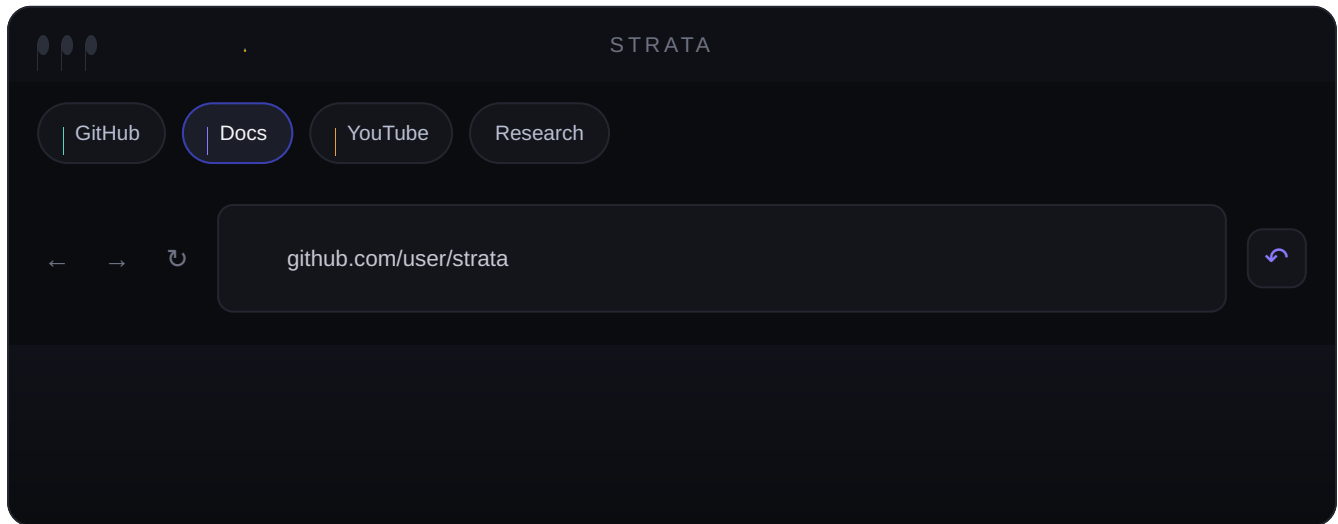
The accent is used sparingly — one primary accent moment per view (the Continuum button, an active tab's ring, a save confirmation). Never accent an entire toolbar or background; that reads as decoration, not signal.

Typography

DISPLAY	Strata
H1	Continuum
H2	Save Current Moment
BODY	Browse in context.
LABEL	REWIND
MONO / CODE	Ctrl + K

A single geometric-humanist sans (system UI stack: Inter or equivalent) across the whole product. Labels and kickers use wide letter-spacing and uppercase to read as structural chrome rather than content — the same trick this document set uses for its own section kickers.

Main Browser Window



The browser chrome is React; website content is Chromium/CEF. Tabs are clean pill-like elements with three quiet states — never more than one indicator per tab at once.

- **Normal**

Teal dot, default surface, secondary text color.

- **Active**

Elevated surface, accent-tinted ring, primary text color.

- **Changed**

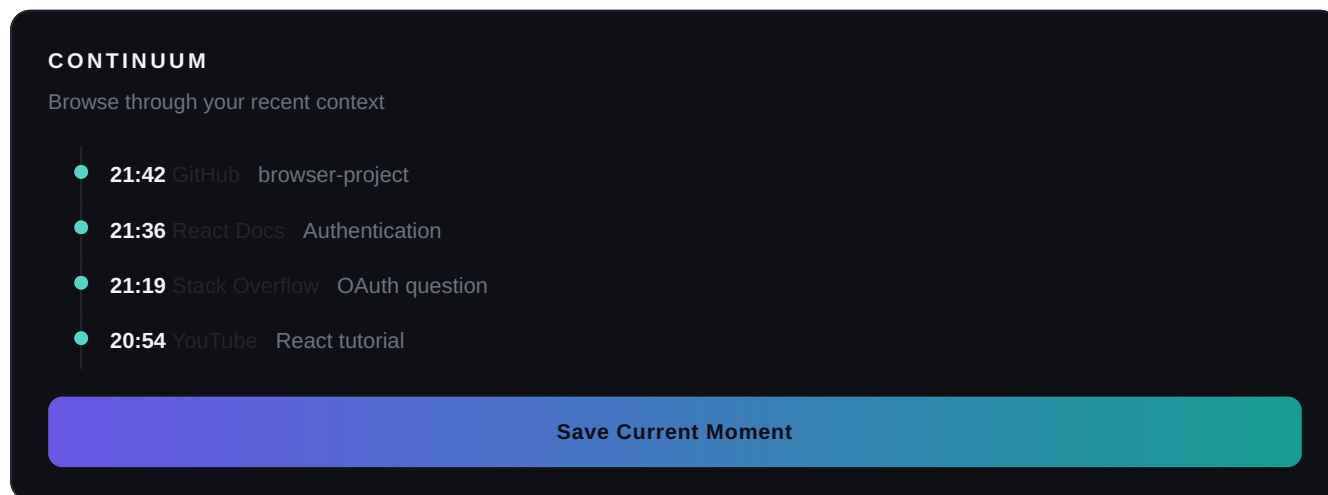
Small amber dot only — reserved for genuine background updates since the browser was last viewed.

Address bar

The visual center of the toolbar. Handles URL navigation, search, a secure-connection indicator, copy/edit URL, autocomplete with history suggestions, and bookmark state — all in one field, no separate search box.

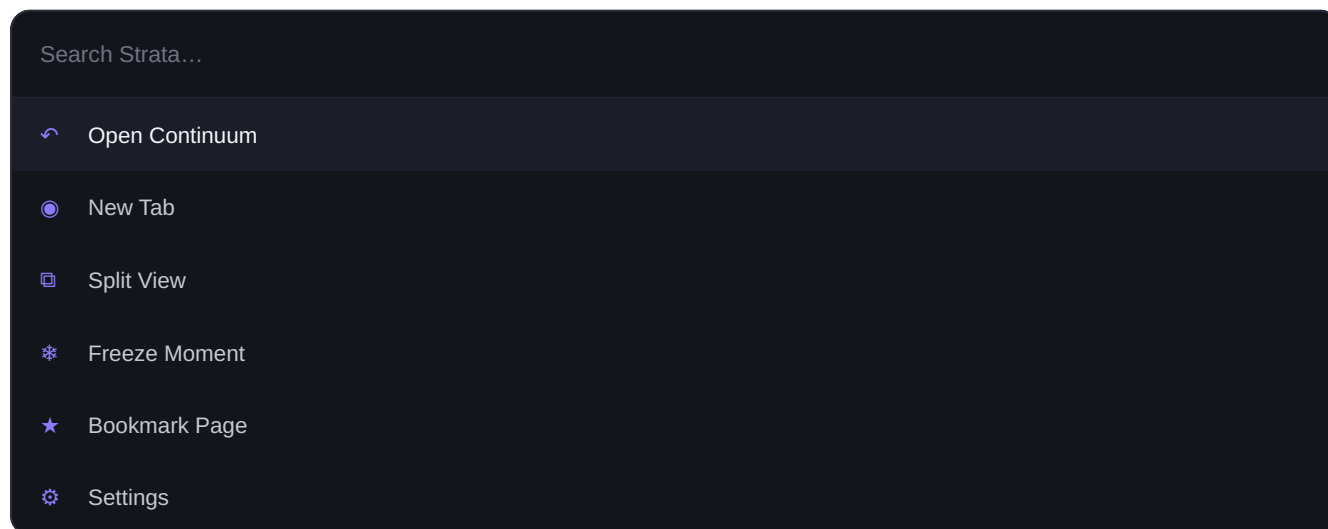
Continuum Button & Panel

The single control that makes Strata legible as different from every other browser. Clicking ↶ opens a right-anchored panel with a vertical timeline of recent context and a persistent action to save the current state.



Command palette — Ctrl + K

Fully keyboard-accessible; every browser and Strata-specific action is reachable without a mouse.



Split View & Freeze

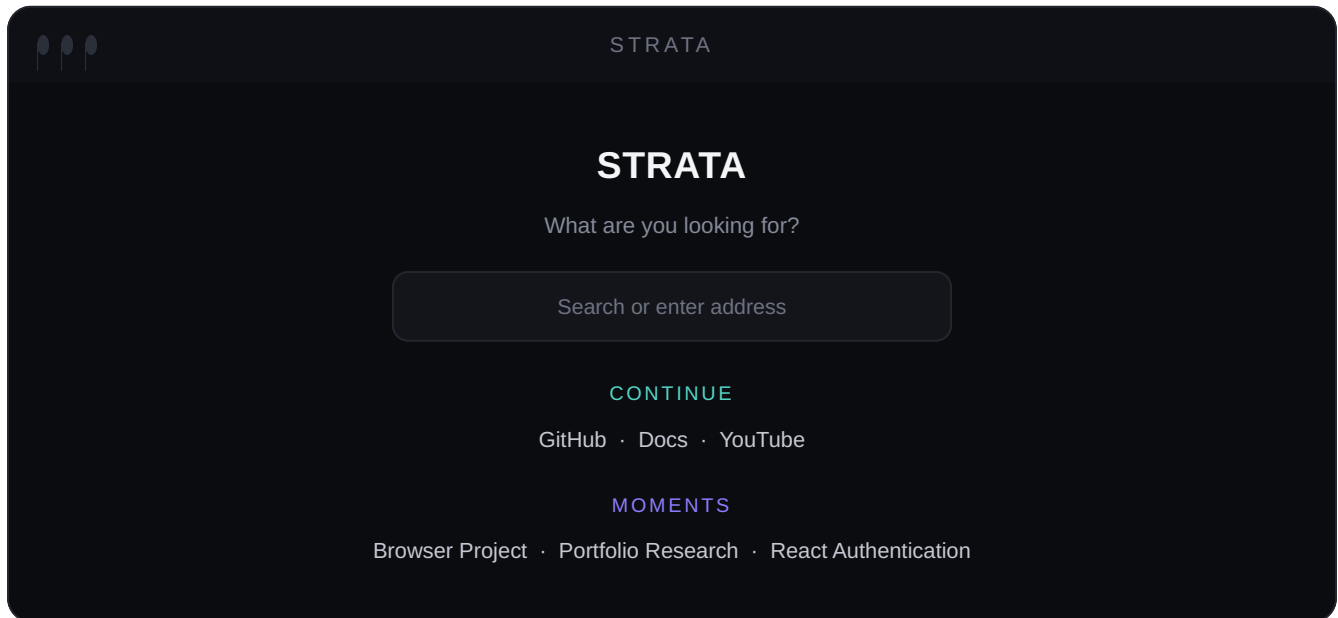
Users drag one tab onto another to create a split. The split relationship becomes part of the Moment — restoring a Moment restores tabs, layout, *and* per-pane scroll position.



Right-clicking a tab surfaces [Freeze Moment](#) alongside standard actions (New Tab, Duplicate, Pin, Mute, Split, Save Moment, Close) — freezing captures context and allows the tab to close immediately.

Homepage

Not a search-engine clone. The homepage states the product's identity in one glance: a search/address field, a row of tabs to continue, and a row of saved Moments — nothing else.



Animation Philosophy

Animation is a confirmation, never a decoration. Every motion value below is deliberately small.

MOMENT	MOTION
Tab opening	scale 0.98 → 1, opacity 0 → 1
Continuum panel	smooth slide + fade, ~180–220ms
Moment restoration	brief "Restoring Moment..." list of tab names, then a natural transition into the restored workspace — never an abrupt cut

RESTRAINT

Don't use excessive animation. If a motion doesn't communicate state change (loading, arriving, confirming), cut it.

Keyboard Shortcuts

Essential

Ctrl+L	Address bar
Ctrl+T	New tab
Ctrl+W	Close tab
Ctrl+Shift+T	Restore closed tab
Ctrl+R	Reload
Alt+←/→	Back / Forward
Ctrl+D	Bookmark
Ctrl+H	History
Ctrl+J	Downloads
Ctrl+K	Command palette
Ctrl+Tab	Next tab

Strata-specific

Ctrl+Shift+M	Save Moment
Ctrl+Shift+R	Open Continuum
Ctrl+Shift+F	Freeze Moment

Shortcuts are user-adjustable in Settings. Every menu action shown elsewhere in this document carries a shortcut where one exists — the palette and menus are the discoverability layer, not the primary interaction model, for power users.

Logo & Brand Mark

The mark is a stylized **S**, or a layered geometric form — a direct visual reference to the "strata" concept of stacked layers. It appears as a small rounded-square glyph (see this document's own cover) rather than a literal wordmark icon.

✓ **Say**

"Browse in context." "Don't just reopen a tab. Reopen where you left off." "The browser that remembers your place."

✗ **Never say**

"AI-powered browsing." "The future of the web."
"Supercharged productivity."